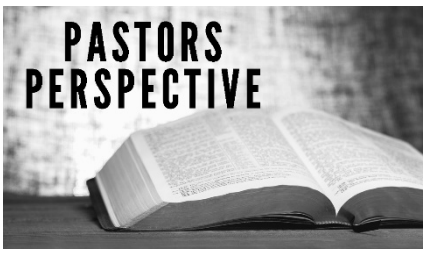
July 2026 Volume 30, Issue 7

THE ROCKY HOCK ANCHOR

The Mission of Rocky Hock Baptist Church is to magnify Christ and make disciples of all people.



"You Will POP In Due Time!"

Ecclesiastes 3:1-8 – "To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven: 2 A time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted; 3 A time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up; 4 A time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance; 5 A time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing; 6 A time to get, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away; 7 A time to rend, and a time to sew; a time to keep silence, and a time to speak; 8 A time to love, and a time to hate; a time of war, and a time of peace."

As I sat down to write this month's newsletter article, my mind was drawn back to an article that I had written waaay back in 2024, entitled "You Will POP In Due Time!" The more I tried to write… the more I was drawn back to this specific write-up. Throughout the day, it "popped" into my mind several times… and I felt like the Holy Spirit was leading me to re-share it with you. When God lays something on our hearts, we must be obedient. I believe it's a seasonal word and I have no doubt that the Lord is going to use it again to bless someone in a special way. Maybe it's you?

What do the following questions have in common? "You want some more butter with that?", "How many minutes should I leave it in for?", "You want me to throw some cheese on there for ya?" If you guessed "quotes from the Paula Deen show" … you'd be on the right track! *But you'd be wrong.* All of these questions relate to the cooking and preparation of *popcorn*!

When I was a little boy, popcorn really wasn't my "go to" snack… but in recent years, my palate has matured and Julianna and I go through *at least* two bags of popcorn per week! *We especially love the kernels*.

Anyways… all this talk about popcorn has (made me hungry, and) stoked my curiosity about a few things. What actually happens inside the popcorn bag? Have you ever thought about that? Why doesn't the bag catch on fire? How does the butter spread so evenly amidst the popping process?

And perhaps most importantly… why do *some* kernels pop more quickly than others? I mean, *why don't they all just pop at the same time*?! They're all in the same microwave, at the same temperature, under the same pressure, right? … and yet some just pop sooner than others. *It's a timing thing, I suppose.*

Today, I need you to understand something about God's timing. God is *always* on time. He's never late. And even though you may feel like He hasn't heard your prayers, or that He's abandoned you, or that He hasn't delivered you - God is on the job. He is in control and His promises are true… *they're just not always on our timetables.*

Whether things are popping or not! … God is in control and we can trust Him! So, take a deep breath and say… "I trust you, God." Be patient. You will "pop" in due time, if ye faint not! Your prayers will "pop" in due time, too! Sometimes, we just don't get our answers right away! Keep praying, amidst the heat, church family! God is up to something!"

Pastor Trey Rogers
Senior Pastor



Join us on **Sunday, July 5th for Ice Cream & Fireworks @ 7:30 PM** on the lawn of the Multi-Purpose Building. Be sure to bring your own chair! This event will take the place of our regular 6 PM Sunday night Youth & Children Activities and Evening Worship.

BAPTIST MEN



The Baptist Men's Breakfast will be **on Sunday, July 19th at 7:30 AM** in the Special Function Room. Gentlemen, please join us for food, fellowship, and a devotion!



Our next Blood Drive is July 21st from 1:00 – 6:00 PM. We all know July 4th, 1776, is the birth of our country, and this year is our 250th celebration. Have you ever thought about the birth of the American Red Cross? It was founded by Clara Barton on May 21, 1881, and was dedicated to serving people in need. The Red Cross received the first congressional charter in 1900, and to this day it is tasked by the federal government with providing services to members of the military and their families, as well as providing disaster relief in the U.S. and around the world.

Even while the Red Cross adapts to the changing needs of the people they serve, they always try to stay true to their roots. Are you familiar with the classic images of the Red Cross nurses helping our soldiers and civilian war victims during WW1? In fact, Red Cross staff and volunteers are still deployed alongside our military. Have you ever taken a class through the Red Cross, such as first aid, CPR certification, or how to swim? Did you know similar training has been offered since the early 1900's? Have you ever given blood or received donated blood? The Red Cross developed the first nationwide civilian blood program in the 1940s, and they still provide more than 40% of the blood products in this country.

Today, as throughout their long history, the Red Cross depends on generous contributions of time, money, and especially blood to support their lifesaving services and programs. Can you find the time this July to donate blood? If you're unable to donate, consider volunteering. You'll not regret the feeling that you will have knowing that you've helped save a life. Make your appointment now at redcrossblood.org and enter RHBC. You can also call 1-800-RED-CROSS, or download the American Red Cross Blood app. If you have questions or need help with your appointment, call or text Rhonda Bass at 252-337-5766.

You can be a "star" for our patients when you donate blood at our Blood Drive. All donors will receive a Fandango movie ticket (up to $15) by email.



Our next Church Conference will be on Wednesday, July 29th at 7 PM in the Sanctuary, followed by Prayer Meeting, if time permits. All Committees / Ministry Teams should submit a written report (via email to lbunch@rhbce.org or by dropping it off at the Church Office) no later than 12:00 Noon on the date of Conference.

Youth and Children will follow the regular Wednesday night schedule: VSM (6th - 12th Graders) at 6:45 PM in the Youth Suite, GA's & RA's (Girls and Boys in 1st - 5th Grades) at 6:45 PM in the Special Function Room for a meal, Mission Friends (3 - 5 year olds) at 7 PM in the 2 year olds Classroom.



ALIVE IN CHRIST

From: devotions 4teens.com

Background Story: The book of Ephesians was written by the Apostle Paul as a letter to the church of Ephesus, most likely when he was in prison in Rome. Read more at https://biblehub.com/ephesians/

Read: Ephesians 2:1-10

[1]As for you, you were dead in your transgressions and sins, [2] in which you used to live when you followed the ways of this world and of the ruler of the kingdom of the air, the spirit who is now at work in those who are disobedient. [3] All of us also lived among them at one time, gratifying the cravings of our flesh and following its desires and thoughts. Like the rest, we were by nature deserving of wrath. [4] But because of his great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, [5] made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in transgressions—it is by grace you have been saved. [6] And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus, [7] in order that in the coming ages he might show the incomparable riches of his grace, expressed in his kindness to us in Christ Jesus. [8] For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God— [9] not by works, so that no one can boast. [10] For we are God's handiwork, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do.

Big Idea: We who were dead, are made alive in Christ.

When God placed the tree of the knowledge of good and evil in the garden and gave Adam and Eve a choice, God said, "when you eat from it, you will certainly die" (Genesis 2:17). When they sinned, death came. Not just physical death, where a person dies at the end of their life. But spiritual death that immediately separated man from God.

It is vitally important that we understand this truth. A person who has not put their faith and trust in Jesus, is dead in their sin. Because of this truth, we read in this passage, they follow the instincts of the enemy and the cravings of their sinful nature. And they have no ability to do otherwise. They can try hard to do better, but they can never live a life that pleases God (Romans 8:7-8). They have no ability to do so, because they are still dead in their sin.

When Jesus came, He died that we might have LIFE! A believer who has put their faith and trust in Jesus and received forgiveness of sins through His death and resurrection, is not a 2.0 better version of themselves. They are not a nicer, happier, more helpful version of the person they used to be. Nor are they like a zombie, who is a walking dead person. No - they are a new creation (2 Corinthians 5:17) with a new heart (Ezekiel 36:26), born again (John 3:3-7)! Once dead, unable to do that which pleased God, they are now alive and given the Holy Spirit with new desires and the power from God to accomplish them (Philippians 2:13).

It is foolish to expect the world to behave as though they were not dead. And for the believer, it is foolish to be alive and live as though you are still dead. Those who have put their faith and trust in Him, have stepped out from the grave! Like Lazarus, take your grave clothes off and live (John 11:43-44)!
Take time to re-read this AMAZING scripture passage and reflect on what it means to be alive in Christ.

Takeaway Verses: Ephesians 2:1, 4-5

Song For Today: Big Daddy Weave – *"Alive"*

Baptist Women

The Long Way Around: When God's Calling Leads Through the Wilderness

From Tarheel Talk, Spring 2026, By Amanda Martinsen

God's call does not always lead us forward as quickly or as easily as we may hope, but it always leads us deeper.

After 400 years of slavery, God had delivered His people from Egypt with power and unmistakable authority. The chains were broken. The exit was clear. And yet, almost immediately, God led them in a direction that made little sense. Scripture tells us that instead of taking the shortest road to the Promised Land, God led Israel the long way, through the wilderness (Exodus 13:17–18).

It wasn't a detour due to poor planning. It was intentional. God knew His people. He knew that immediate battles might cause them to want to turn back. So, He led them slowly, faithfully, one step at a time, the long way around.

As they traveled, the Lord went before them in a pillar of cloud by day and a pillar of fire by night. This visible sign of God's presence was constant. It guided them when the path was unclear and reassured them when the nights felt long. Scripture emphasizes that the pillar never left them. God did not deliver His people and then send them off alone. He was always present with them.

The wilderness proved to be a time of great preparation. Throughout those years, God provided everything they needed. Psalm 105 reminds us that He covered them, fed them, gave them water in dry places, and remembered His promises. The journey shaped a people who would eventually be ready to move forward into the land He had promised. That pattern has not changed. God still calls His people, and He still often leads them through seasons that feel longer, harder, and more uncertain than expected.

The wilderness today for you may look like grief, a season of transition, unanswered prayers, or a calling that feels bigger than your confidence. It can feel disorienting to follow God when the route doesn't match our expectations of what we think should be happening. Yet calling is rarely formed in comfort.

Mission flows from a faith that has learned to trust God's presence before it sees His provision. Just as Israel learned to follow the pillar day by day, believers today are shaped by the Spirit's leading. It is often in quiet obedience, unseen faithfulness, and perseverance through difficulty.

The Israelites carried with them the bones of Joseph, a reminder that God keeps His promises across generations. In the same way, our lives carry visible markers of God's faithfulness. What He has sustained us through becomes a testimony meant to be shared.

This is where mission begins. May we be awakened to the ways God has not only carried us through the wilderness seasons but is calling us to share our testimony with others who need to hear of His great faithfulness.

A world that is weary from broken promises does not need perfect messengers. It needs faithful ones. When we walk through the wilderness with trust in God's presence, we become living evidence that He is good, near, and worthy of surrender. Our obedience, forged in the long way around, becomes an invitation for others to follow Him too.

If God has you in a wilderness season, take heart. He is still leading. He may be preparing you not just for what lies ahead, but for who He is calling you to serve.

What if the long road is not delaying your calling, but shaping it?

Who might encounter the faithfulness of God because you chose to trust Him in the wilderness?

Remember, the wilderness is never the final destination. God is faithful in it, and He is faithful to lead us through it. And when God brings us through, our lives become a living testimony that hope endures and His faithfulness remains.

Deacon Team of the Week

6/28/26 – 7/4/26
J.C. Forehand, Scott Noble, Mike Evans

7/5/26 – 7/11/26
Russell Byrum, Matthew Evans, Phil Smith

7/12/26 – 7/18/26
Adam Bunch, Ted Peele, Oscar White

7/19/26 – 7/25/26
Steve Evans, Roger Smith, Chris Turner

7/26/26 – 8/1/26
Donald Bass, Allen Peele, Sam Tynch

July Deacon Greeters

Senior Adult Building: Matthew Evans

Sanctuary Main Entrance: Adam Bunch

Connecting Corridor: Allen Peele

Multi-Purpose Main Entrance: Sam Tynch

July Ushers

Billy Elliott, Jasper Evans, Danny Lewis,
Phil Smith, Gail Boyd, Joshua White

July Offering Team

Adam Bunch (Lead), Wayne Bunch,
Carroll Evans, Phil Smith,
Paul Ward, Oscar White

July Counting Committee

Ed & Judy Hughes, Leon Hemmings, Keith Rollins



Sunday Attendance:	SS	AM	PM
5/31/26:	141	312	No Service
6/7/26:	164	258	85
6/14/26:	135	265	67
6/21/26:	146	217	No Service

Wednesday PM Attendance:

6/3/26:	64
6/10/26:	45
6/17/26:	68
6/24/26:	58

Edenton-Chowan Food Pantry

The request from RHBC this month is:

Peanut butter



Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON



DATE . . . . . Saturday, August 1, 2026
(No Rain Date)

PLACE . . . . . Occano
105 Scotch Hall Court, Merry Hill

START . . . . . Shotgun Start at 9:00 AM,
Pre-Registration at 8:30 AM

FORMAT . . . . . Four Man Superball

ENTRY FEE . . . . . $350.00 per team
(Silver Super Tee Shot)

TEAMS CAN BE MADE UP OF ALL MEN, ALL WOMEN, OR MEN AND WOMEN MIX

1st & 2nd Place Teams will be recognized. Lunch will be served after the Tournament.

ALL proceeds from the tournament will go to The North Carolina Baptist Children's Homes.

***Occano Dress Code*: Jeans or denim shorts are not allowed. Pants or shorts must be khaki. No Tee Shirts. Shirt must have a collar. No metal spikes on shoes. *DRESS CODE WILL BE ENFORCED*. You will not be allowed to play if not properly dressed.**

ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES ARE NOT ALLOWED!

DEADLINE FOR ENTRY IS FRIDAY, JULY 24TH

You may contact Trey Bass (484-9406), Neal Tynch (312-9362), or Ellis Tynch (333-0388) for more information or call the Church Office (221-4133).

TEAM NAME / MEMBERS: _____

_____

SPONSORSHIP: _____ Team ($350) _____ Donation (any amount) _____ Hole Sponsor ($100)

SEND ENTRY FORM AND CHECK TO: **Rocky Hock Baptist Church**
113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, NC 27932

CHILDREN'S PAGE for children of all ages



Independence Day

July 4th



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ADAMS
AMERICA
BARBECUE
COLONIES
CONGRESS
DECLARATION
EQUALITY
FIREWORKS
FOURTH
FREEDOM
HOTDOGS
INDEPENDENCE
JEFFERSON
JULY
LIBERTY
NATION
PARADE
REVOLUTION
RIGHTS
STATES
THIRTEEN
UNITED



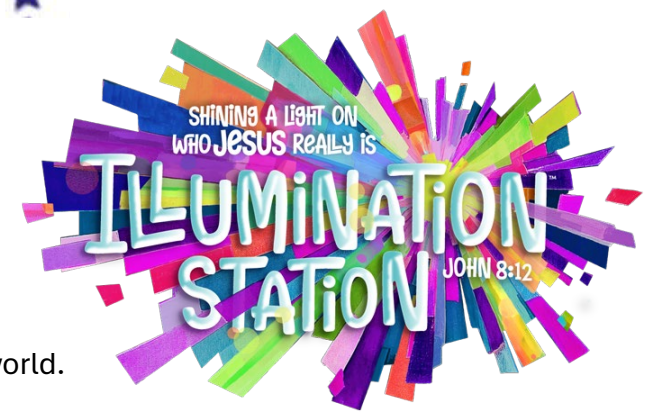
centrikid camps

What is CentriKid?
CentriKid Camp is for 2nd–6th graders to experience the time of their lives and learn more about the message of Jesus Christ!

CentriKid is staffed by young adults with a passion for hanging out with kids and sharing Christ through everything they do!

RHBC's Children are attending
July 27th – 31st
@ Ridgecrest, NC

Vacation Bible School 2026
July 6 - 10 from 5:30 - 8:30 PM



At Illumination Station VBS, kids will be challenged to answer Jesus' important question to His disciples, "Who do you say that I am?" As they explore all the ways light brightens, illuminates, reflects, and reveals, kids will discover that Jesus is the light who brings hope to a dark world.

Jesus spoke to them again: "I am the light of the world. Anyone who follows me will never walk in the darkness but will have the light of life." ~ John 8:12

Rocky Hock Baptist Church
113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, NC 27932

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Check us out on the web at www.rhbce.org

Sundays:
9:45 AM - Sunday School for all ages
11:00 AM - Morning Worship (Nursery & Children's Church available for 3 year olds - 5th Grade); Worship Online at www.rhbce.org, our Facebook page, vimeo, and YouTube
6:00 PM - Evening Worship - ***"DEEP DIVE"*** - Adults in Sanctuary, Youth in Youth Suite, Children in Gym

Wednesdays:
6:45 PM - Vertical Student Ministries (VSM) - Middle & High School Youth - Youth Suite; GA's (1st-5th Grade Girls) - GA's Room, beside foyer; RA's (1st-5th Grade Boys) – RA's Room, upstairs (meal provided for GA's & RA's in Special Function Room)
7:00 PM - "**WORSHIP** *Seeds*" for Adults - Sanctuary; Mission Friends (3-5 year olds) - 2 year old Room

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Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor, trogers@rhbce.org
Office: 252-687-2086 Cell: 706-994-2652

Allen Nixon, Deacon Chair Cell: 252-312-7966

Linda B. Bunch, Administrative Assistant
lbunch@rhbce.org Office: 252-221-4133

Deborah Long, Custodian
Mary Jo Bass, Treasurer
Trey Bass, Security
Donna Peele, Pianist

Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON